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Group#04

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Lab Instructor: **Dr Noreen Shah**

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Group Report: Communication Analysis of "Save Our Park!" Role-Play

1. Introduction

The role-play "Save Our Park!" illustrates a conflict between community activists (Israr, Hizbulah, Musawair) and a construction team (Rahim, Shameer) over the demolition of a public park. While initial interactions were confrontational, the group eventually reached a compromise. This report analyzes communication failures, cultural influences, and actionable solutions to prevent similar disputes.

2. Misunderstandings and Root Causes

2.1 Communication Breakdowns

Aggressive vs. Defensive Language: Israr's emotional appeal ("You can't destroy our park!") triggered Rahim's dismissive response ("That's final"), escalating tension.

Ineffective Data Presentation: Musawair's environmental data was initially ignored due to Rahim's focus on legalities and budgets.

2.2 Cultural Factors

Tradition vs. Modernity: Hizbulah's emphasis on the park's cultural value clashed with Rahim's profit-driven priorities.

Hierarchy: Rahim's authority delayed compromise until Shameer reframed the issue as a financial opportunity (e.g., tax incentives).

3. Prevention Strategies

To avoid similar conflicts:

Active Listening: Mediators (like Shameer) should facilitate dialogue early by acknowledging concerns. Cultural Bridging: Use shared values (e.g., Hizbulah's village example) to align goals. Evidence-Based Negotiation: Lead with data and benefits (e.g., Musawair's later pitch linking eco-design to investor appeal).

4. Solutions

Short-Term Actions:

- Host a structured meeting with all stakeholders to review alternatives (e.g., underground parking).
- Draft a joint statement of intent to demonstrate collaboration.

Long-Term Recommendations:

- Implement a community-review process for future projects.
- Train teams in cross-cultural communication and conflict resolution.

5. Conclusion

The conflict stemmed from poor communication and cultural mismatches but was resolved through mediation and reframing the problem. Future projects should prioritize inclusive planning and evidence-based proposals to balance community, environmental, and economic needs.